Application Assignment #2: Claim Types and Burden of Proof

GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Prepare - Understand General Expectations

First time completing an Application Assignment?
Start by reviewing the Application Assignments Overview

Prepare - Review the Learning Material

To set yourself up for success, please check out these resources before you begin:

- [ ] GE.150 | Reading 3.1
- [ ] GE.150 | Podcast 3.1
- [ ] GE.150 | Reading 3.2
- [ ] GE.150 | Podcast 3.2

Assignment Example

Use this example as a model for your work, but ensure you choose a **different argument and concept** for your own assignment.

- Application Assignment #2 Example

Assignment Steps

Assignment Steps	
Prepare	**Download the Assignment Template:** Application Assignment Template
1. Find an argument.	Go online and find a **recent** post, article, or video

Application Assignment #2: Claim Types and Burden of Proof

GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Assignment Steps	
	where someone is trying to prove a point (in other words, an argument). Here are some ideas on where to find arguments: • **Social media posts** (e.g., Facebook, X, Instagram, TikTok), especially from public figures (e.g., politicians, celebrities). You can also use comments on original posts. • **News outlets** (e.g., CNN, Fox, NYTimes, The Blaze, local media) • **Op-Eds or Editorials:** NYTimes opinion, The Guardian opinion, USA opinion. • **Governments and Organizations:** Representatives (democrats, republicans), the White House, social movements
2. **Pick an idea.**	Choose one of the following concepts: • Claim of Fact • Claim of Value • Claim of Policy • Presumption • Burden of Proof *Tip: If a concept doesn't work well, choose a new argument or an approved concept!*
3. **Show your source.**	Share the link to the argument or take a picture (screenshot) of it.
4. **Explain it.**	1. **Describe the argument:** Tell me exactly what the argument is about. What is the author's main point (claim)? What facts or stories (evidence) do they use to prove it? How do they connect those facts to their point (reasoning)? 2. **Teach the concept:** Imagine you are explaining your chosen concept to a

Application Assignment #2: Claim Types and Burden of Proof

GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Assignment Steps	
	younger sibling or a friend who wasn't in class. How would you describe it in your own words? 3. **Show the weakness:** Use that concept to explain why this argument is weak. Where does it fail or break down?
5. **Make it better.**	Suggest how the person could make their argument stronger or clearer.

Prepare for Submission

- ☐ **Check your assignment!** Use the checklist in the assignment template and use the grading rubric below.
- ☐ **Ask AI for feedback.** Use the AI prompt at the end of the assignment template to coach you on ways to improve your assignment.
- ☐ **Submit a shareable Google Doc Link.** If your document does not work the first time, you automatically lose a point.

Late Submission Policy

- -20% from the total score for 1 to 3 days late.
- -40% from the total score for 4 to 7 days late.
- -60% from the total score for 8 to 11 days late
- -80% from the total score for 12 days late.

Grading Rubric
Total Grading Breakdown

Application Assignment #2: Claim Types and Burden of Proof

GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

---

10 points possible. 10/10 = 100%, 9/10 = 90%, 8/10 = 80% and so on.

1.1 Find an argument.

- **2 points (Full Credit):** You found an online public argument that is recent (less than a year old) and shows the concept nicely.
- **1 point (Partial Credit):** You found an online public argument that is not recent, but shows the concept nicely.
- **1 point (Partial Credit):** You found an online public argument that is recent (less than a year old); however, it shows the concept poorly.
- **0 points (No Credit):** You did not find an online public argument, or it is irrelevant to the chosen concept.

2.1 Pick an idea.

- **1 point (Full Credit):** You chose a concept approved for the assignment.
- **0 points (No Credit):** You did not choose an approved concept.

3.1 Show your source.

- **1 point (Full Credit):** You provided an accessible URL for a video, image, post, or article, or included a screenshot that shows the entire argument (e.g., social media post)
- **0 points (No Credit)**: The source is inaccessible, or it is difficult to determine the entire scope of the argument.

4.1 Explain it: Describe the argument.

- **1 Point (Full Credit)**: You clearly explained the whole argument. You identified the main point (claim), the facts/stories used (evidence), and how they connected them (reasoning).
- **0.5 Point (Partial Credit)**: You explained the argument, but you missed one part (like the evidence or the reasoning), or it was a bit confusing to follow.
- **0 Points (No Credit)**: You didn't describe the argument, or your description was too short to understand what the author was saying.

4.2 Explain it: Teach the concept.

Application Assignment #2: Claim Types and Burden of Proof

GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

- **1 Point (Full Credit)**: You explained the class concept so clearly that someone who has never been to our class could understand it. You used your own words.
- **0.5 Point (Partial Credit)**: You defined the concept, but it sounded like you just copied a dictionary or a textbook. A "beginner" might still be a little confused.
- **0 Points (No Credit):** You didn't explain the concept, or the explanation was incorrect.

4.3 Explain it: Show the weakness.

- **2 Points (Full Credit)**: You did a great job using the class concept to prove why the argument is weak. You pointed out exactly where the argument fails and why.
- **1 Point (Partial Credit):** You mentioned that the argument is weak, but you didn't use the class concept very well to explain why. Your explanation might be a bit "surface-level."
- **0.5 Point (Low Credit)**: You said the argument was weak, but you didn't provide any real reasons or use the class concept at all.
- **0 Points (No Credit):** You didn't explain why the argument was weak.

5.1 Explain it: Show the weakness.

- **2 Points (Full Credit):** You gave a clear, helpful suggestion. You explained exactly what the author should add or change (like a specific type of fact or a clearer explanation) to make their point stronger.
- **1 Point (Partial Credit):** You gave a general suggestion, like "they should use more facts" or "they should write better," without explaining how to do it.
- **0 Points (No Credit):** You didn't give a suggestion, or your suggestion doesn't help fix the problem.

Working Google Doc Link

- You will lose one (1) point if your Google Doc shareable link does not work the first time.

Application Assignment Template

GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Your Name:	*Bobby Smith.*
Application Assignment #...	*2*

Step #1 & #3: Find Your Argument and Show Your Source

https://www.whitehouse.gov/articles/2026/02/president-trump-is-delivering-for-texans/

Application Assignment Template

GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Date of the Source:

- 02/26/2026

Step #2: Pick an Idea

- **Burden of Proof**

Step #4: Explain It

Describe your argument:

I took a look at the headline and clicked through the whole article to see what was going on. Basically, this argument is just one big victory lap for President Trump's policies in Texas. The main point is that his administration is the direct reason life in Texas is supposedly getting better—especially with things like cheaper gas, lower taxes, and all these new tech jobs.

To prove it, the author throws out a bunch of massive numbers, like gas being down 44% and families saving over $4,000 on taxes this year. The reasoning is a super simple "A caused B" setup: they're claiming that since these good things are happening while Trump is in office, his specific moves—like mass deportations or those new tax cuts—must be the "smoking gun" behind it all.

Teach the Concept:

The "Burden of Proof" is basically the rule that says if you're the one making a big, bold claim, it's on you to provide the receipts. You can't just say something wild and then act like it's everyone else's job to prove you wrong. Think of it like a friend claiming they can do a backflip; they have the "burden" to actually show you the flip before you have to believe them. If they just stand there and say, "Well, you can't prove I *can't* do one," they haven't actually won the argument.

Application Assignment Template

GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Show the Weakness:

This argument trips up because it doesn't actually meet the burden of proof for its biggest claims. For example, it says mass deportations made houses in Austin 8% cheaper. That's a huge connection to make, but the author doesn't show any data or studies proving that one actually caused the other—they just list two things that happened at the same time and hope you don't ask questions. It also takes credit for $60 billion from Texas Instruments, but it doesn't prove the company invested because of Trump specifically, rather than just liking Texas's existing vibe, like having no state income tax.

Step #5: Make it better.

To make this actually stick, the author needs to connect the dots with real "why" and "how" evidence. Instead of just saying gas prices dropped, they should point to a specific order or energy policy that directly led to more supply. If they want to claim credit for those big tech investments, they should show a quote from a CEO saying the new tax cuts were the exact reason they picked Texas over another state. Basically, they need to stop just listing "cool things that happened" and actually show the paper trail.

Assignment Checklist: Aim for 100%

1. Find Your Argument (2 Points)

- [X] Is the argument from the internet?
- [X] Is it "public" (can anyone see it)?
- [X] Is it less than a year old?
- [X] Does it clearly show the class concept you picked?

2. Pick Your Idea (1 Point)

- [X] Did you check the "Approved Concepts" list for this assignment?
- [X] Did you pick one of those specific ideas?

3. Show Your Source (1 Point)

Application Assignment Template

GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

- [X] Did you include a working website link (URL)?
- [X] **OR** Did you include a screenshot that shows the *entire* argument so the teacher can read the whole thing?

4. Describe the Argument (1 Point)

- [X] Did you state the main point the author is making (**Claim**)?
- [X] Did you list the facts, stories, or data they used (**Evidence**)?
- [X] Did you explain how they tried to connect their facts to their point (**Reasoning**)?

5. Teach the Concept (1 Point)

- [X] Did you explain the class concept in your own words?
- [X] Would someone who is NOT in this class understand it after reading your explanation?

6. Show the Weakness (2 Points)

- [X] Did you use your class concept to prove why the argument is weak?
- [X] Did you point out the exact spot where the argument fails or breaks down?

7. Suggest an Improvement (2 Points)

- [X] Did you give a specific "how-to" step to fix the argument?
- [X] Instead of just saying "add more facts," did you suggest a *specific* kind of fact or a *specific* change the author should make?

Application Assignments

Overview | GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Overview Video

Here's a video that provides an overview of these assignments:

🎬 GE.150 Application Assignment Overview

What's an Application Assignment?

Quick Facts	
Description:	An opportunity to apply a class concept to an argument you find online to exercise your critical thinking muscles!
Meet course learning outcomes (CLOs):	1, 2, 3
Total Assignments:	**7 total.** These are spread throughout the quarter.
Estimated Time Commitment:	**60-90 minutes each.** Timing depends on how quickly you find a public argument to analyze.
% of Final Grade:	About 7.86% each (55% total towards your grade)
Late Policy:	**Each assignment has a unique late policy**. At the beginning of the quarter, we accept more late work as we become familiar with the class. Towards the end, we accept fewer late application assignments.
Resubmission Policy:	**It depends on the situation**. We encourage continual improvement, so reach out to your instructor and TA.
Early Submissions:	**You are welcome to work ahead and complete these assignments before the due date.** If you choose this route, you must learn about a concept on your own and apply it. Otherwise, wait until we cover the topic in class.

Application Assignments

Overview | GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Quick Facts	
AI Policy	**Yes:** For brainstorming where to find arguments or coaching you on how to improve. **Cautiously:** For minor polishing to your writing. **No:** For writing or analyzing an argument.
General Topics	**Each assignment fits with a general theme:** 1. Artistic Proofs 2. Claim Types and Burden of Proof 3. Stock Issues 4. Toulmin Model 5. Evidence 6. Statistics 7. Fallacies

What will I do?

Each application assignment (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, and 7) will follow these general guidelines:

General Assignment Steps	
Prepare	**Download the Assignment Template:** Application Assignment Template
1. Find an argument.	Go online and find a **recent** post, article, or video where someone is trying to prove a point (in other words, an argument). Here are some ideas on where to find arguments: • **Social media posts** (e.g., Facebook, X, Instagram, TikTok), especially from public figures (e.g., politicians, celebrities). You can also use comments on original posts. • **News outlets** (e.g., CNN, Fox, NYTimes, The Blaze, local media) • **Op-Eds or Editorials:** NYTimes opinion, The Guardian opinion, USA opinion.

Application Assignments

Overview | GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

General Assignment Steps	
	• **Governments and Organizations:** Representatives (democrats, republicans), the White House, social movements
2. Pick an idea.	Choose one topic from the list of approved concepts we learned in class. Here is a running list of approved concepts for each assignment: Application Assignments | Approved Concepts *Tip: If a concept doesn't work well, choose a new argument or an approved concept!*
3. Show your source.	Share the link to the argument or take a picture (screenshot) of it.
4. Explain it.	1. **Describe the argument:** Tell me exactly what the argument is about. What is the author's main point (claim)? What facts or stories (evidence) do they use to prove it? How do they connect those facts to their point (reasoning)? 2. **Teach the concept:** Imagine you are explaining your chosen concept to a younger sibling or a friend who wasn't in class. How would you describe it in your own words? 3. **Show the weakness:** Use that concept to explain why this argument is weak. Where does it fail or break down?
5. Make it better.	Suggest how the person could make their argument stronger or clearer.

Example Assignments

Application Assignments

Overview | GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Examples:	
Application Assignment #1 Example Application Assignment #1 Exampl…	Application Assignment #5 Example
Application Assignment #2 Example	Application Assignment #6 Example
Application Assignment #3 Example	Application Assignment #7 Example
Application Assignment #4 Example	

How will I be graded?

Each application assignment has the following rubric:

Grading Rubric
Total Grading Breakdown
10 points possible. 10/10 = 100%, 9/10 = 90%, 8/10 = 80% and so on.
1.1 Find an argument.
• **2 points (Full Credit):** You found an online public argument that is recent (less than a year old) and shows the concept nicely. • **1 point (Partial Credit):** You found an online public argument that is not recent, but shows the concept nicely. • **1 point (Partial Credit):** You found an online public argument that is recent (less than a year old); however, it shows the concept poorly. • **0 points (No Credit):** You did not find an online public argument, or it is irrelevant to the chosen concept.
2.1 Pick an idea.
• **1 point (Full Credit):** You chose a concept approved for the assignment. • **0 points (No Credit):** You did not choose an approved concept.

Application Assignments

Overview | GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

3.1 Show your source.
• **1 point (Full Credit):** You provided an accessible URL for a video, image, post, or article, or included a screenshot that shows the entire argument (e.g., social media post) • **0 points (No Credit)**: The source is inaccessible, or it is difficult to determine the entire scope of the argument.
4.1 Explain it: Describe the argument.
• **1 Point (Full Credit)**: You clearly explained the whole argument. You identified the main point (claim), the facts/stories used (evidence), and how they connected them (reasoning). • **0.5 Point (Partial Credit)**: You explained the argument, but you missed one part (like the evidence or the reasoning), or it was a bit confusing to follow. • **0 Points (No Credit)**: You didn't describe the argument, or your description was too short to understand what the author was saying.
4.2 Explain it: Teach the concept.
• **1 Point (Full Credit)**: You explained the class concept so clearly that someone who has never been to our class could understand it. You used your own words. • **0.5 Point (Partial Credit)**: You defined the concept, but it sounded like you just copied a dictionary or a textbook. A "beginner" might still be a little confused. • **0 Points (No Credit):** You didn't explain the concept, or the explanation was incorrect.
4.3 Explain it: Show the weakness.
• **2 Points (Full Credit)**: You did a great job using the class concept to prove why the argument is weak. You pointed out exactly where the argument fails and why. • **1 Point (Partial Credit):** You mentioned that the argument is weak, but you didn't use the class concept very well to explain why. Your explanation might be a bit "surface-level." • **0.5 Point (Low Credit)**: You said the argument was weak, but you didn't provide any real reasons or use the class concept at all. • **0 Points (No Credit):** You didn't explain why the argument was weak.

Application Assignments

Overview | GE.150 Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

5.1 Explain it: Show the weakness.
• **2 Points (Full Credit):** You gave a clear, helpful suggestion. You explained exactly what the author should add or change (like a specific type of fact or a clearer explanation) to make their point stronger. • **1 Point (Partial Credit):** You gave a general suggestion, like "they should use more facts" or "they should write better," without explaining how to do it. • **0 Points (No Credit):** You didn't give a suggestion, or your suggestion doesn't help fix the problem.

GE.150 | Reading 3.1

Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Argumentation 101: Building Your Case Without the Fight

When you hear the word "argument," you might think of two people shouting at each other over a parking spot or what to have for dinner. But in college—and in your career—an argument is something much more professional. It's like building a house: you need a solid foundation, strong walls, and a roof that ties it all together.

For many of you, being an online student means you're already an expert at "building cases." Maybe you had to convince your boss to give you a flexible schedule, or you had to explain to your kids why "pizza night" is now "study night." In this reading, we'll learn the three main tools you need to make those arguments unstoppable.

The Triple Threat (Claim, Evidence, and Reasoning)

Every good argument has three ingredients. If you're missing one, the whole thing falls apart.

1. **The Claim**: This is your main point. It's the "What" of your argument. It's the statement you want others to believe is true.
2. **The Evidence**: This is the "How do you know?" It's the facts, data, or expert testimony that supports your claim.
3. **The Reasoning**: This is the "So what?" It's the logic that connects your evidence to your claim. It explains *why* the facts prove your point.

The Relatable Example: Imagine you're trying to convince your spouse that you should buy a new laptop for your online classes.

- **Claim:** "I need a new laptop to succeed in my degree."

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

- **Evidence**: "My current laptop freezes three times an hour, and it doesn't meet the requirements for the new software my professor assigned."
- **Reasoning**: "If my laptop keeps freezing, I will miss deadlines and lose points. Therefore, a reliable computer is necessary for me to pass my classes."

  Pause and Reflect: Think about a time you asked for something—a raise, a favor, or a change in schedule. What was your claim? Did you provide enough evidence to back it up?

What Kind of Claim Are You Making?

Not all claims are the same. In the world of critical thinking, we usually put them into three buckets:

1. Claims of Fact

These are statements about whether something is true or false, or whether something actually happened. You can usually prove these with data or research.

- *Example:* "Online students spend an average of 15 hours a week on coursework."

2. Claims of Value

These are about what is good or bad, right or wrong, or better or worse. They are based on your personal beliefs or standards.

- *Example:* "Taking classes online is a more rewarding experience than sitting in a traditional classroom."

3. Claims of Policy

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

These are about what *should* be done. They usually suggest a specific action or a change in rules.

- *Example:* "The college should provide free childcare for students during final exam week."

  Pause and Reflect: Look at the following statement: "Remote work is better for mental health than working in an office." Is this a claim of Fact, Value, or Policy? How would you prove it?

Building Your Own Argument

Now it's your turn. To be a great critical thinker, you don't just "have an opinion"—you build a case.

- **Step 1:** Pick your Claim. Be clear. Instead of saying "Degrees are good," say "Getting a degree in Business will increase my earning potential by 20%." (Claim of Fact).
- **Step 2:** Gather Evidence. Look for real numbers. "According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics, people with a Bachelor's degree earn significantly more per week than those with only a high school diploma."
- **Step 3**: Connect with Reasoning. "Since I am currently working a low-wage job, completing this degree is the most direct path to financial stability for my family."

When you combine these three, you aren't just "complaining" or "asking"—you are demonstrating logic. This is the skill that gets you promoted, helps you win debates, and ensures you aren't easily fooled by flashy ads or fake news.

Final Pause and Reflect: If you had to make a Claim of Policy to your local city council about something in your neighborhood, what would it be? What one piece of evidence would be most likely to convince them?

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

GE.150 | Reading 3.1

Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Summary

- **Claim**: What do I want them to believe?
- **Evidence**: What facts do I have?
- **Reasoning**: How do the facts prove my point?
- **Fact Claim**: Is it true?
- **Value Claim**: Is it good/bad?
- **Policy Claim**: Should we change the rules?

Learning Resources

Study this reading using this AI prompt	Check out the podcast for this reading:
Act as an "Argument Architect." My goal is to master the "Argumentation 101" material provided below so I can build "unstoppable" cases in my writing and my career. Please lead me through this interactive session: 1. **The Blueprint Phase**: Ask me to pick a "Real-Life Goal" (e.g., asking for a promotion, convincing a landlord to make repairs, or advocating for a change in a school policy). 2. **The Construction Challenge**: Once I pick a goal, ask me to provide the "Triple Threat": - A clear **Claim**. - One piece of solid **Evidence**. - The **Reasoning** that connects them. 3. **The Bucket Test**: Give me three different statements related to my chosen goal. I must identify which one is a **Claim of Fact**, which is a **Claim of Value**, and which is a **Claim of Policy**.	GE.150 | Podcast 3.1

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

GE.150 | Reading 3.1

Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

4. **The Inspector's Critique**: Review my argument. Tell me if my "house" is sturdy or if the foundation (the evidence) or the roof (the reasoning) is missing. Wait for my response after each step. Use a professional yet encouraging tone, acknowledging the busy life of a non-traditional student. Here is the material: [PASTE THE TEXT OF THE ARTICLE HERE]	

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

GE.150 | Reading 3.2

Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

The Art of the Argument: A Guide for the Modern Thinker

Welcome to your first step in becoming a master of logic! Whether you are balancing a full-time job, raising a family, or just trying to navigate the endless stream of information on the internet, critical thinking is your secret weapon.

Arguments aren't just about shouting matches on social media. In the world of logic, an argument is a way of using reasons to support an idea. Today, we are going to look at the "rules of the game" and a handy toolbox called the Stock Issues Framework.

Who Starts the Fight? (Presumption and Burden of Proof)

Imagine you are in an online class meeting, and a classmate says, "I think we should all have to keep our cameras on for the entire three-hour lecture."

Your first instinct might be to say, "No way!" But in a logical debate, we have two important concepts to decide who has to speak first: Presumption and the Burden of Proof.

Presumption: The "Status Quo" Advantage

Presumption is like the "home-field advantage." It belongs to the way things are right now (the *status quo*). If the current rule is that cameras are optional, "Presumption" stays with the optional rule. We assume the current way is okay until someone proves otherwise.

Burden of Proof: The Heavy Lifting

The Burden of Proof belongs to the person who wants to change things. If your classmate wants to mandate cameras, *they* are the ones who have to provide

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

strong reasons why. You don't have to prove they are wrong until they've actually made a solid case.

> Pause and Reflect: Think about your own life. If you wanted to ask your boss for a flexible work schedule, who has the "Presumption" (the current way) and who has the "Burden of Proof"? Why?

The Art of the Argument: Your "Stock Issues" Checklist

Imagine you are at a town hall meeting—or more likely, in a heated Slack channel at work. Someone shouts, "We need to change how we do things!"

In the world of logic, that person has just taken on the **Burden of Proof**. They are the ones asking for change, so they are the ones who have to prove why the change is worth it. To do that successfully, they need a map. In debate and logic, we call this map the **Stock Issues Framework**.

Think of Stock Issues as a "pre-flight checklist" for an argument. If you miss one, the whole plane might stay on the ground.

We will cover these stock issues in more detail over the next few readings. The ideas below present a brief overview!

Policy Claims: "What Should We Do?"

A policy claim is a call to action. You aren't just stating a fact; you're proposing a rule or a law. To win this argument, you must answer four specific questions.

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

GE.150 | Reading 3.2

Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

The Ill (Significance)

The Question: Is there even a problem in the first place? If you can't prove something is broken, why fix it?

- **Example:** "Our current scheduling software crashes twice a week, causing us to miss client deadlines." (That's a significant "ill.")

The Blame (Inherency)

The Question: Is the problem "built-in" to the current system? You have to show that the problem won't just go away on its own. There are two types of barriers:

- **Structural Barriers:** These are literal rules or physical hurdles. *Example: "The software is 15 years old and literally cannot run on our new laptops."*
- **Attitudinal Barriers:** These are "mood" or "habit" hurdles. *Example: "Management thinks the crashes are just 'user error' and refuses to look at new options."*

The Cure (Solvency)

The Question: Is your plan workable and practical? Will it actually solve the problem?

- **Example:** "Switching to 'CloudSchedule' will stop the crashes because it runs on external servers, not our old hardware."

The Cost (Desirability)

The Question: Do the benefits outweigh the downsides? In every policy change, there is a trade-off.

- **Example:** "Yes, the new software costs $200 a month, but we will save $2,000 a month by not losing clients due to missed deadlines."

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

> Pause and Reflect: Think about a rule at your current job or school that you dislike. Is the barrier to changing it Structural (a written policy) or Attitudinal (just "the way we've always done it")?

Value Claims: "Is This Good or Bad?"

Value claims are about opinions, morals, or aesthetics. You aren't asking for a law; you're asking for a judgment.

The secret to winning a value argument is **Criteria Selection**. Since words like "better," "worse," or "fair" are subjective, you have to define the "ruler" you are using to measure them.

Example Claim: "Working from home is better than working in an office."

- **If your Criterion is "Productivity":** You might argue that home is better because there are fewer interruptions from coworkers.
- **If your Criterion is "Team Synergy":** You might argue the office is better because it's easier to brainstorm in person.

To win, you must convince your audience that *your* criterion is the most important one.

Factual Claims: "Is This True?"

Factual claims aren't about what we *should* do or what is *good*; they are about what **is**.

Example Claim: "Students who use AI tutors score 20% higher on math tests."

To test this, we look at two things:

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

GE.150 | Reading 3.2

Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

1. **Definition:** What does the proposition actually mean? Does "AI tutor" mean a simple chatbot, or a sophisticated software program? Does "score 20% higher" mean on one quiz or the final grade?
2. **Evidence Sufficiency:** Is there enough data to support the claim?
    - If the study only looked at five students, the evidence is **insufficient**.
    - If the study was funded by the company selling the AI, the evidence is **biased**.

Pause and Reflect: You see a headline that says, "Coffee drinkers live longer." Before you believe it, what is one question you should ask about the Evidence Testing?

Summary

Next time you are trying to persuade your boss, your spouse, or your local government, run your idea through this list:

- **Policy:** Is there a real problem? What is stopping it from being fixed? Does my solution work? Is it worth the cost?
- **Value:** What "ruler" am I using to judge this? Is it the right ruler for the situation?
- **Fact:** Are my definitions clear? Do I have enough reliable evidence to prove this is true?

Mastering these "Stock Issues" doesn't just make you a better debater; it makes you a critical thinker.

Learning Resources

Study this reading using this AI prompt	Check out the podcast for this reading:
Act as a "Logic Consultant." I want to	GE.150 | Podcast 3.2

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

master the "Stock Issues Framework" and the concepts of "Burden of Proof" from the reading material provided below. Please lead me through this simulation: 1. **The Status Quo Test**: Give me a scenario where someone wants to change a rule (e.g., at a workplace or a local school). Ask me to identify who has "Presumption" and who carries the "Burden of Proof." 2. **The Policy Proposal (The 4 Stock Issues)**: I will propose a change (like "Employees should have a 4-day work week"). Guide me through the checklist one by one. Ask me to identify: - The **Ill** (What is the significant problem?) - The **Blame** (Is it a Structural or Attitudinal barrier?) - The **Cure** (How exactly does my plan solve the Ill?) - The **Cost** (Do the benefits outweigh the downsides?) 3. **The Value Judgment**: Give me a "Value Claim" (e.g., "Online learning is better than in-person learning"). Ask me to pick a **Criterion** (a ruler) to measure it and explain why that ruler is the most important one. 4. **The Evidence Audit**: Present me with one "Factual Claim" backed by weak evidence. Ask me to "audit" it based on the definitions and sufficiency mentioned in the text. Wait for my response after each step. Give me feedback like a mentor—be direct but encouraging.	

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.

GE.150 | Reading 3.2

Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking

Here is the material: [PASTE THE TEXT OF THE ARTICLE HERE]	

This content is sourced from Google Gemini and reviewed for accuracy.